



PROGRESS REPORT

Eritrea: progress report, August 2025 – August 2026

Edition of 2026-08-26 · 13 systems and instruments tracked

GOVERNANCE · FINANCE · ICT INFRASTRUCTURE · DPI · DIGITALISATION · TECHNOLOGY · CAPACITY · INCLUSION · DATA · GEOPOLITICS · WHERE THE RECORD IS THIN

This report asks the same set of questions of every country. The rows below are a fixed frame of indicators, one row each, chosen in advance and covering all thirty-eight subjects the base tracks — so what appears here is decided by the frame and not by whichever records happened to accumulate. Each row says what happened on that indicator during the period, with every claim linked to the source it rests on.

Where a row reads *No evidence*, the base holds nothing on that indicator. **That is a statement about this base, not about the country** — it does not mean nothing exists, only that nothing has been collected here yet. The rows that carry evidence say what it is; the rows that do not are left to speak for themselves.

The period is 2025-08-01 to 2026-08-26.

Progress values. *Advanced* — a system entered service, a stage was completed or an instrument was made. *Stalled* — a stated target passed without delivery. *Regressed* — an instrument was withdrawn or neutralised, or a reported position worsened. *Mixed* — the indicator's instruments moved in different directions in the period; the clause after the comma names which moved which way. *No change* — the base holds a standing position and nothing in the period touched it. *No evidence* — the base holds nothing on this indicator at all. A value may carry a qualifying clause after a comma, as in *Advanced, regulations still pending*.

Governance

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Strategies, plans and policies	Digital transformation strategy		NO EVIDENCE
Strategies, plans and policies	ICT strategy		NO EVIDENCE
Strategies, plans and policies	Broadband strategy		NO EVIDENCE
Strategies, plans and policies	Data storage / cloud strategy		NO EVIDENCE
Strategies, plans and policies	Data interoperability framework / roadmap		NO EVIDENCE
Strategies, plans and policies	AI strategy		NO EVIDENCE
Strategies, plans and policies	Data localisation policies		NO EVIDENCE
Strategies, plans and policies	Data governance policy		NO EVIDENCE

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Strategies, plans and policies	Open data policy		NO EVIDENCE
Legislation and regulation	Data protection legislation		NO EVIDENCE
Legislation and regulation	Cybersecurity legislation		NO EVIDENCE
Legislation and regulation	Legislation covering digital id		NO EVIDENCE
Legislation and regulation	Digital payments legislation		NO EVIDENCE
Legislation and regulation	Legislation enabling data interoperability		NO EVIDENCE
Legislation and regulation	AI legislation / regulations		NO EVIDENCE
Legislation and regulation	E-commerce legislation		NO EVIDENCE
Legislation and regulation	Statistics legislation		NO EVIDENCE
Legislation and regulation	Access to information legislation		NO EVIDENCE
Data protection	Data protection authority		NO EVIDENCE
Data protection	National data protection readiness		NO EVIDENCE
Regional collaboration	Regional policy collaboration		NO EVIDENCE
Regional collaboration	Regional legal harmonisation		NO EVIDENCE
Regional collaboration	Shared regional infrastructure		NO EVIDENCE
Regional collaboration	Cross-border data transfers		NO EVIDENCE
Standards	National interoperability standards		NO EVIDENCE
Standards	National quality standards		NO EVIDENCE
Standards	Adoption of international standards		NO EVIDENCE
Public debate and participation in policymaking	Non-governmental contribution to national policy		NO EVIDENCE
Public debate and participation in policymaking	Open discussion of government policy		NO EVIDENCE

Finance

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Domestic budget appropriations and expenditure	Sustainable domestic financing of digital transformation		NO EVIDENCE
MoUs and other agreements	Strategic relationships		NO EVIDENCE

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
New investments	Mobilisation of non-state finance		NO EVIDENCE
New investments	Development-partner project financing	UNDP's statistical-capacity grant to the National Statistics Office runs to 2026 and is the only development-partner financing on the ledger. The standing position is a US\$1,676,837 UNDP grant to the Government of Eritrea and the National Statistics Office, committed in 2019 with an end year of 2026 . Nothing in the twelve months to 2026-08-26 records a disbursement, an extension or a successor, and no second development partner appears anywhere on this ledger. The grant funds the statistical work reported under Censuses and surveys, so what movement there is shows up there rather than here.	NO CHANGE

ICT Infrastructure

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Connectivity	Mobile penetration	Active connections reached 859,000, or 23.7% of the population, up 8.2% year on year, among the lowest rates in Africa. 2025-11-08 — DataReportal's Digital 2026 report for Eritrea puts active mobile connections at 859,000, 23.7% of the population, 49.3% of them broadband, and up 8.2% on the year . The previous edition is the comparison. The direction is upward and the level is among the lowest in Africa. Both statements are true, and the second governs what sits downstream of it: a foundational digital ID, mobile money and any service assumed to reach a citizen through a handset all rest on this figure. No operator or regulator return on the ledger tests it.	ADVANCED
Connectivity	Internet usage		NO EVIDENCE
Connectivity	Mobile affordability		NO EVIDENCE
Connectivity	National fibre backbone	The ministry reports about 73km of new cable laid and landline plant renovated in six towns; no independent measure of the backbone exists. 2026-05-19 — the minister responsible for communications reported 184 towers installed, about 73km of new cable laid, and landline plant renovated in six named towns and at the Naval Force Base , against a claimed cumulative investment above 35 billion Nakfa. The figures are the ministry's own, carried by state media, and nothing on the ledger tests them: no operator disclosure, no regulator return and no third-party measurement of the network appears for Eritrea in the window. EriTel remains the sole operator.	ADVANCED on the ministry's own figures

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Connectivity	International internet bandwidth	Bandwidth is reported at about 1,536 Mbps after a decade of growth, and it is carried by satellite: no submarine cable lands in Eritrea. 2026-05-19 — the ministry put international bandwidth at about 1,536 Mbps, risen over the past decade . 2026-04-16 — the industry position is unchanged: Eritrea is still the only one of Africa's coastal states with no cable landing , and cable firms describe a country that does not answer landing requests. An earlier account of the same position dates it to June 2024. EriTel's international transit therefore runs on geostationary satellite, which is what a bandwidth figure of this size describes. The growth is real and the ceiling is the technology carrying it.	ADVANCED on a ministry figure, with no cable landing behind it
Connectivity	Internet Exchange Points		NO EVIDENCE
Connectivity	Satellite broadband licensing and availability	Starlink lists Eritrea with no planned launch date, one of seven African states without a timetable; the base holds no licence application or refusal. 2026-07-17 — Starlink's own availability map still lists Eritrea as having no planned launch date , leaving it one of seven African states with no announced timetable, all of them in North Africa and the Horn. The position is the one the base carried at the start of the window. What is not on the ledger is any Eritrean decision: no application, no refusal and no regulatory statement about satellite broadband appears, so the absence is recorded from the operator's side only.	NO CHANGE
Data Storage	Local data centre capacity (all providers)		NO EVIDENCE
Data Storage	Local data centre capacity (national providers)		NO EVIDENCE
Data Storage	Off-site backup capacity		NO EVIDENCE
Energy	Sufficient energy and water for data centres		NO EVIDENCE
Energy	Grid reliability		NO EVIDENCE
Energy	Rural electrification		NO EVIDENCE
Technical Capacity	Robustness of government hardware and software		NO EVIDENCE
Technical Capacity	Local capacity to maintain, manage and develop government systems		NO EVIDENCE
Cybersecurity	National cybersecurity readiness		NO EVIDENCE

DPI

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Data Exchange	National data exchange system		NO EVIDENCE
Data Exchange	Use of digital id in other systems		NO EVIDENCE
Data Exchange	Interoperability of health systems		NO EVIDENCE
Data Exchange	Interoperability of education systems		NO EVIDENCE
Data Exchange	Interoperability of social protection systems		NO EVIDENCE
Digital Identity and CRVS	Robustness of system	The base holds no operational foundational digital ID, a position profiled in July 2025 and untouched since. 2025-07-26 — a digital identity index profile found no operational foundational identity system and set out what one would face: low connectivity and mobile penetration, thin digital infrastructure, a telecom monopoly and weak civil registration. Nothing in the twelve months to 2026-08-26 changes that. No enrolment programme, procurement, pilot or legal instrument on digital identity appears on the ledger, so the standing position is carried forward on a single profile written just before the window opened.	NO CHANGE
Digital Identity and CRVS	Registration of entire population	With no foundational system in service, no share of the population is registered into one, and nothing in the window changes that. The same 2025-07-26 profile that finds no operational foundational identity system names weak civil registration among the barriers a future one would face, which is the nearest the base comes to a statement about coverage. No enrolment figure exists to report, because there is nothing to enrol into. The population counting the base does hold is the survey work reported under Censuses and surveys, which is a statistical exercise and not a register.	NO CHANGE
Digital Identity and CRVS	National maintenance of id and credentials systems		NO EVIDENCE
Digital Identity and CRVS	Authentication		NO EVIDENCE
Digital Identity and CRVS	Digital id from birth		NO EVIDENCE
Digital Identity and CRVS	Interoperability of birth registration and digital id		NO EVIDENCE
Digital Identity and CRVS	Use by other systems		NO EVIDENCE

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Digital Payments and Fintech	Governance role of central bank	The Bank of Eritrea gave holders of cash outside the banking system until 31 July 2026 to deposit it, on pain of legal action. 2026-07-02 – a legal notice from the Bank of Eritrea ordered cash held outside banks deposited by 31 July 2026 , with legal action threatened against holders who do not comply. The notice defines no threshold for the excessive holding it names and states no enforcement mechanism. It is the only central-bank action on this ledger, and it addresses the cash economy rather than any payment system: no named mobile-money or digital-payments service appears anywhere on the base for Eritrea.	ADVANCED an instrument aimed at the cash economy rather than at payment
Digital Payments and Fintech	G2P functionality		NO EVIDENCE
Digital Payments and Fintech	Revenue collection		NO EVIDENCE
Digital Payments and Fintech	B2B and B2G functionality		NO EVIDENCE
Digital Payments and Fintech	P2P, P2G and P2B functionality		NO EVIDENCE
Digital Payments and Fintech	Population uptake		NO EVIDENCE
Digital Payments and Fintech	Cross-border functionality		NO EVIDENCE
Digital Payments and Fintech	Consumer protection		NO EVIDENCE
Registries	Population register		NO EVIDENCE
Registries	Civil register		NO EVIDENCE
Registries	Address register		NO EVIDENCE
Registries	Business register		NO EVIDENCE
Registries	Social protection register		NO EVIDENCE
Registries	Electoral register		NO EVIDENCE
Registries	Tax register		NO EVIDENCE
Registries	Land register		NO EVIDENCE
Sectoral management information systems	Health		NO EVIDENCE
Sectoral management information systems	Education		NO EVIDENCE
Sectoral management information systems	Social protection		NO EVIDENCE
Sectoral management information systems	Justice		NO EVIDENCE
Sectoral management information systems	Tax		NO EVIDENCE

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Sectoral management information systems	Customs	ASYCUDA World was inaugurated on 8 January 2026, replacing customs software dating from 2007, with the source code transferred to the government. 2026-01-08 – ASYCUDA World entered service , replacing customs software in use since 2007. UNDP supported the implementation and the source code was transferred in full to the Eritrean government, which is the part worth recording: the system is nationally held rather than run on the country's behalf. It is the only sectoral management information system on this ledger, and nothing states what it connects to – no revenue system, no business register and no trade single window appears for Eritrea.	ADVANCED
Sectoral management information systems	Land		NO EVIDENCE
Other GovTech and e-Gov	e-government services		NO EVIDENCE

Digitalisation

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Digitalisation of sub-national government	ICT infrastructure for local government		NO EVIDENCE
Digitalisation of sub-national government	Digitalisation of local government records		NO EVIDENCE
Rural digital data capture	Digitalisation of rural health clinics		NO EVIDENCE
Rural digital data capture	Digitalisation of rural primary schools		NO EVIDENCE
Rural digital data capture	Digitalisation of rural registry offices		NO EVIDENCE
Rural digital data capture	Digitalisation of rural police stations		NO EVIDENCE

Technology

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
AI	Use of AI in government administration		NO EVIDENCE
AI	Use of AI in sectoral management information systems		NO EVIDENCE

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
AI	Development of national / regional AI systems	Eri-Chat, an offline AI application built by a ministry developer, launched in April 2025 and was shown at an Asmara diplomatic event in October. 2025-11-01 — a profile of the developer Naod Goitom Isaac describes Eri-Chat, an offline AI application launched in April 2025 and shown to ambassadors and UN officials at an Asmara UN Day event on 24 October 2025. It works in English only; local-language support waits on training data the developer says does not exist in sufficient quantity. It is one application written by a single software developer at the Ministry of Information rather than a national programme, and it is the only AI system of any kind on this ledger.	ADVANCED
AI	Control of AI abuse		NO EVIDENCE
ICT Industry	National capacity in DT-related production		NO EVIDENCE
Innovation ecosystem	Technology hubs		NO EVIDENCE
Innovation ecosystem	Tech startup ecosystem	A self-organised collective released five Tigrinya-language education applications built to the national curriculum, with no stated funding or distribution channel. 2026-08-15 — an interview carried by the state information ministry describes five applications from the Shambko Apps Group : literacy, puzzle, cultural-heritage and arithmetic tools written against the national curriculum, with a stated plan to extend them to Eritrea's eight other national languages. The group is a private collective rather than a state programme. Nothing is stated about download counts, distribution channel or funding, and no hub, incubator, investor or company registration appears elsewhere on the ledger — so this is one collective on the record, not evidence of a startup base.	ADVANCED

Capacity

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Literacy	Digital literacy (civil service)		NO EVIDENCE
Literacy	Digital literacy (general population)		NO EVIDENCE
Training and skills	DT-related training in secondary education		NO EVIDENCE
Training and skills	DT-related university facilities and qualifications		NO EVIDENCE
Training and skills	Graduates entering DT ecosystem		NO EVIDENCE
Research institutions	Think tanks and academic departments contributing to DT policy		NO EVIDENCE

Inclusion

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Access to services	Citizen feedback portals		NO EVIDENCE
Access to services	Citizen participation in policy		NO EVIDENCE
Access to services	Gender equity		NO EVIDENCE
Access to services	Inclusion of persons with disabilities		NO EVIDENCE
Access to services	Inclusion of refugees and IDPs		NO EVIDENCE
Digital divides	Bridging of digital divides		NO EVIDENCE

Data

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
National statistics	National strategy for development of statistics		NO EVIDENCE
National statistics	Censuses and surveys	The fourth Eritrea Population and Health Survey completed fieldwork in 9,794 households across all six regions, with the report due in 2026. 2026-05-08 — the National Statistics Office reported the fourth Eritrea Population and Health Survey complete: 9,794 households across 405 enumeration areas, a 98.4% household completion rate, and collection by computer-assisted personal interview . Around 400 tables over 20 chapters are drafted, with writing, printing and dissemination scheduled through 2026, so the fieldwork is finished and the published output is not. Technical support came from UNECA and an Oslo consultancy under the UNDP-led Joint Programme on Data for Development. It is the most substantial statistical work the base holds for Eritrea.	ADVANCED
National statistics	Statistics from administrative data	The statistics office compiled national accounts for 2023 and began collection for 2024, the only administrative statistical production the base records. 2026-05-08 — alongside the household survey, the National Statistics Office is reported to have compiled the 2023 national accounts and started data collection for 2024 . That is the whole of the ledger's evidence on statistics drawn from administrative sources, and it is second-hand: the accounts themselves are not on the base, and no statement of which administrative systems feed them appears either. No statistics law and no national strategy for the development of statistics is on record for Eritrea, so this production rests on the office's own practice.	ADVANCED
Open data	Use of open data		NO EVIDENCE
Use of satellite data	Agricultural use of satellite data		NO EVIDENCE

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Use of satellite data	Meteorological use of satellite data		NO EVIDENCE

Geopolitics

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
US / hyperscaler activities	USA / hyperscaler MoUs, engagements and commitments		NO EVIDENCE
China activities	Chinese MoUs, engagements and commitments		NO EVIDENCE
EU activities	EU MoUs, engagements and commitments		NO EVIDENCE
Gulf/UAE activities	Gulf MoUs, engagements and commitments		NO EVIDENCE
India activities	India MoUs, engagements and commitments		NO EVIDENCE

Where the record is thin

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	WHAT WOULD SETTLE IT	LAST PROBED
National foundational digital ID	A named programme, pilot or vendor engagement for a foundational digital-ID system distinct from the passport/civil-registration base already on file.	not yet probed
Submarine fibre-optic cable landing	A licensing decision, application, or a dated update to the Submarine Networks registry's coastal-state count.	not yet probed
Starlink satellite internet service	A licence application, refusal, or an updated Starlink coverage-map entry for Eritrea.	not yet probed
Mobile money / digital payments service	A named mobile-money operator, licence or pilot, or a central-bank statement on digital payments distinct from the cash-deposit ultimatum.	not yet probed
Data-protection law	A published data-protection bill, statute or regulator designation.	not yet probed

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